



1940

Utility range The utility designs created by London fashion houses were not attributed, but this wool suit might be Victor Stiebel's. The jacket shape is reminiscent of British Army battledress.

1942



August 1942 A print frock by the London firm Rahvia appeared in *Picture Post* under the heading "Austerity Clothes For The Fourth Year of The War". Small prints could be easily matched at the seams, reducing waste.



1944

Rationed fur According to a booklet issued by the British Board of Trade, loose fur skins were not rationed but a fur skin made into a "tie" required five coupons. If several skins were used for a tie, each skin required five coupons.

MAKE DO AND MEND

To save materials, the British Board of Trade advised housewives to "make do and mend" and issued pamphlets explaining how this could best be done. Holes were covered with embroidery, shirt tails were used to replace frayed collars, and cheap, surplus army blankets were dyed and made into coats. Many a serviceman was said to have returned from the front to find his wardrobe raided and transformed into clothes for his female relatives – plus fours proving to be particularly useful. Blackout cloth, which could be bought without coupons, was another popular material to use for slacks, petticoats, and knickers.

Wartime pamphlet

